Dose-dense AC → fortnightly paclitaxel + weekly trastuzumab

Four AC cycles every 14 days, then four fortnightly paclitaxel treatments with trastuzumab weekly on Days 1 and 8 of each 14-day block (eight weekly antibody doses). Trastuzumab then continues every 21 days to complete one year total; it is not given with AC.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Heart

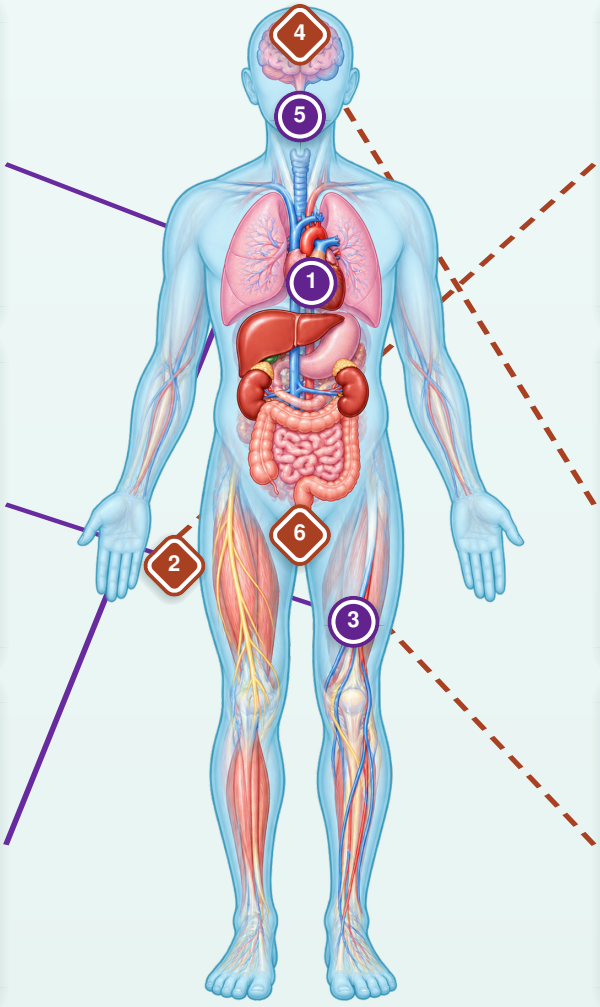
Doxorubicin / trastuzumab

Baseline assessment; report chest pain, breathlessness or swelling.

2 Hands / feet

Paclitaxel

Report numbness or tingling before the next dose.



3 Blood / infection

Chemotherapy phase

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: call immediately.

4 Hair / scalp

Chemotherapy phase

Hair loss is common. Ask about scalp cooling before treatment where suitable.

5 Mouth

Chemotherapy phase

Painful ulcers or difficulty drinking need advice.

6 Bladder

Cyclophosphamide

Report blood in urine or painful urination.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Medicine-specific effects are highlighted; this is not a complete list. New or persistent symptoms still need review after treatment stops.

> Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Doxorubicin

- Low counts, infection and mouth ulcers
- Nausea, hair loss and fatigue
- Heart damage, sometimes delayed
- Severe tissue injury if the infusion leaks
- Rare later blood cancers

Cyclophosphamide

- Low counts and infection
- Nausea, vomiting and hair loss
- Bladder irritation / bleeding
- Fertility effects and menopause
- Rare later blood cancers

Paclitaxel

- Low blood counts and infection
- Numbness / tingling, sometimes lasting
- Hair loss, muscle or joint pain
- Infusion reaction
- Mouth, bowel, skin and nail effects

Trastuzumab

- Heart pumping-function reduction / heart failure
- Infusion or allergic reaction
- Diarrhoea and fatigue
- Rare serious lung effects

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Anti-sickness plan

Follow the prevention and rescue instructions prescribed for this schedule. Call if vomiting prevents drinking.

Infection and bleeding

Know the local urgent-contact number. Fever, shivering, sudden illness or unusual bleeding needs prompt advice even between visits.

Medicine review

Show the oncology pharmacist all prescribed, over-the-counter and herbal medicines. Ask before starting anything new.

Premedicines belong to the active phase

Paclitaxel reaction medicines and AC anti-sickness medicines have different purposes. They are not automatically continued during trastuzumab-only treatment.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00316/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.